How we finalize the Operational App — target launch Mon Nov 16, 2026

Phase	Dates	Who does what	Decision point
1. Fill in & decide	Oct 14 – Oct 23	Aslam fills the 'Info Needed' sheet (Decisions + People first by Oct 16). Aslam picks the build option by Oct 23.	Decision point: sections, build option, texting yes/no
2. Set up data	Oct 19 – Oct 27	Staff fills inventory counts. Assistant loads menu, vendors (Al Markaz, Popeyes, Chef Chen), deliveries (The Bridge, Austin Street, street handout) and shifts. Aslam sends vendor numbers privately; Google Voice (469) 573-4691 set as default call/text app on admins' phones.	Aslam checks the data sheet
3. Build test app	Oct 26 – Oct 30	Assistant connects the preview to the real (private) data with sign-in for owners/admins.	Aslam approves the test app
4. Test	Nov 2 – Nov 6	2 admins + 3–5 volunteers use it on a real Saturday (Oct 31 or Nov 7): check-in, hours, menu, counts.	Collect feedback
5. Fix & train	Nov 9 – Nov 13	Assistant fixes issues; 15-minute how-to for admins; kiosk set up on a tablet.	Aslam gives go/no-go Nov 13
6. Launch	Mon Nov 16, 2026	Share link with admins and volunteers; first live week; check in after first Saturday.	—

Build option	Cost	How it works	Notes
A. Google Sheet + our own web app (recommended)	$0/month	Private Google Sheet holds the data; Apps Script with sign-in; the app you saw (works on phone/desktop, installable). We already run the checklist this way.	Assistant builds; changes need the Assistant
B. AppSheet (Google)	Free if Maa's gets Google Workspace for Nonprofits (includes AppSheet Core); otherwise Starter $5 or Core $10 per user/month	Point-and-click app on a Google Sheet. Free editor with up to 10 test users.	Easy for staff to edit; per-user cost without Workspace
C. Glide	Classic Maker $60/mo ($49/yr) or Business $249/mo (30 users); GlideOS from $25/mo	No-code app on a Google Sheet	Good looks; highest cost

Texting: Google Voice (updated Oct 13)
Calls and texts go out from Maa's Google Voice number (469) 573-4691. Cost: free. Google Voice has no API, so the app opens Google Voice with the order text ready (phone: Call/Text buttons open the Google Voice app via tel:/sms: links, Google Voice must be the default calling/texting app; computer: voice.google.com opens in a new tab and the text is copied to paste). Trade-off: nothing is sent automatically, so vendor orders and shift reminders each need one tap to send. If automatic texts are wanted later, add Twilio (about 1.2¢ per text + ~$20 one-time registration + small monthly fees).

Prices checked Oct 13, 2026: twilio.com/en-us/sms/pricing/us, twilio.com/en-us/phone-numbers/a2p-10dlc, about.appsheet.com/pricing, support.google.com/a/answer/10100275, glideapps.com/classic/pricing, glideapps.com/pricing.